Online Appendix "Political Science Under Pressure: Competition and Collaboration in a Growing Discipline, 2003-2023"

(not intended for publication)

A Glossary

SJR (SCImago Journal Rank) is a metric used in Scopus to assess the impact and prestige of academic journals. A key feature of SJR is that it is a Prestige-Weighted Metric: it measures the scientific influence of journals by considering both the number of citations they receive and the prestige of the journals where those citations come from. Unlike raw citation counts, SJR assigns higher value to citations from more influential journals. Specifically, SJR is the number of citations in a specific year (e.g., 2023) to articles published in the previous three years (e.g., 2020–2022), considering the prestige of the citing journals.

B Data Collection

In general, there are two approaches to systemically map an academic discipline, each with its pros and cons. Choosing between them entails a trade-off.

One approach is to first map the scholars who make the discipline; for example, by assembling the names of all standing faculty in political science departments (nationally or globally, depending on the study's objective). This is the approach taken by Leifeld et al. (2017) when analyzing trends in political science scholarship in Germany. One advantage of this approach is that it allows tracing all publications of political science faculty whether these are published in political science outlets, or elsewhere (e.g., in general interest science journals or journals associated with related fields. Another advantage is that it allows enumerating faculty's publications beyond peer reviewed journals, including monographs and books chapters. In essence, this approach assumes that political science's discipline's output is simply what political scientists, hired by academic departments, publish.

While using scholars as the start point has its benefits, it also comes with a major drawback: selecting on success and survival. This is especially problematic for studies that wish to (also) explain publication success. As always, selecting on the dependent variable introduces bias. Using academics as a start point has another drawback: it omits publications written by those who are not hired by political science departments, including academics from related disciplines, non-academics, graduate students who ended up not taking academic jobs, etc. In short, using political scientists as a start point is a problem if we assume that political science's output as a discipline is what gets published in political science outlets, irrespective of the home institution of the author. As Wæver (p. 697 1998) argued "Journals are the most direct measure of the discipline itself."

These problems are solved if the starting point is political science journals (irrespective of the author's status and institution). This approach does not suffer from selection on survival and success, and it does not arbitrarily omit publications in political science journals just because their author is (currently) not hired by a political science department. Of course, using political science journals as a starting points also has drawback: we underestimate the productivity of scholars who published in non-Political Science outlets. Since our goal is to account for trends in political science as a discipline (and not trends of political scientists), we chose journals as our starting point, and complemented information about authors' publications outside PS journals using Scopus's metadata. Below we describe how we moved from the names of political science journals to assemble four attribute datasets that capture a 21-year period (2003-2023): (a) journal-level dataset, (b) article-level dataset, (c) author-level dataset, (d) commenter-level dataset. In addition, we assemble two relational dataset: (e) network of authors, and (f) network of authors and commenters.

Journal-level data

Our starting point is the full list of all 188 political science journals as classified by Clarivate — an analytics company that provides tools for scientific research and academic performance evaluation via its Web of Science platform. This number of journals is a marked improvement on past reviews of the discipline that generally only uses a sample of journals: for example, Fisher et al. (1998) base their trends analysis on three journals; Wæver (1998) uses seven journals, Kristensen (2012) uses 59 journals, Metz and Jäckle (2017) use 96 journals and Carammia (2022) bases their analysis on 100 journals.

We first drop 3 journals that are not on Scopus, 3 journals that are not peer-review, 7 journals that do not publish in English (e.g., Historia Y Politica), and one journal listed in SCOPUS as a book-series aggregation type, leaving us with a set of 174 peer-review, English language, political science journals. We then used journal names to match each journal listed by Clarivate to the journal's metadata as measured by Scopus, a comprehensive bibliographic database for academic research managed by Elsevier. Our journal-level data includes information such as yearly publication count, yearly citation count, and most importantly, for our analysis of publication success, Scoups's metrics that allow assessing the journal's relative performances, such as CiteScore, SNIP (Source Normalized Impact per Paper), and SJR (SCImago Journal Rank).[17] In addition, for each journal we calculate additional variables such as the number of unique authors (including by gender), and the type of articles it publishes, by methods and topics.

[17]See Appendix Section A for a glossary of measures and concepts used throughout this manuscript.

Table B1: Top 20 Journals

Title	Coverage Start	N Paps	w/ Full Text	Mean SJR	2023 SJR
American Political Science Review	1906	1269	1268	6.07	5.07
International Organization	1947	594	594	5.38	4.93
American Jrnl of Political Science	1982	1341	1341	5.81	4.63
Political Analysis	1989	641	641	5.12	4.61
Comparative Political Studies	1968	1267	1267	2.90	3.49
Political Communication	1980	661	660	1.94	3.35
European Jrnl of Political Research	1973	1220	1220	2.10	3.33
British Jrnl of Political Science	1971	1093	1093	2.77	3.32
World Politics	1948	373	366	3.71	3.02
Jrnl of Public Admin. Research & Theory	1991	799	791	3.12	2.98
Jrnl of Politics	1939	2013	2011	3.12	2.79
Political Behavior	1979	862	862	2.15	2.69
Political Science Research & Methods	2018	356	356	2.34	2.43
Quarterly Jrnl of Political Science	2006	248	246	3.08	2.03
Jrnl of Conflict Resolution	1957	1182	1175	2.89	1.86
Jrnl of Peace Research	1964	1158	1151	2.50	1.74
Public Opinion Quarterly	1937	844	835	1.92	1.64
International Security	1984	580	0	3.30	1.58
International Studies Quarterly	1978	1273	1271	2.30	1.50
European Union Politics	2000	593	593	2.27	1.38

Table B2: Journal Sample Composition

Journal Title	**ISSN**	**Journal Title**	**ISSN**	**Journal Title**	**ISSN**
		In Sample (With Text)			
International Organization	0020-8183	Political Communication	1058-4609	American Political Science Review	0003-0554
Contemporary Security Policy	1352-3260	Environmental Politics	0964-4016	Political Analysis	1047-1987
European Journal of Political Research	0304-4130	British Journal of Political Science	0007-1234	Comparative Political Studies	0010-4140
World Politics	0043-8871	Policy and Internet	nan	International Journal of Press/politics	1940-1612
Global Environmental Politics	1526-3800	Political Psychology	0162-895X	Journal of Chinese Political Science	1080-6954
Review of International Political Economy	0969-2290	Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory	1053-1858	West European Politics	0140-2382
American Journal of Political Science	0092-5853	Journal of European Public Policy	1350-1763	New Political Economy	1356-3467
Political Geography	0962-6298	Review of International Organizations	1559-7431	Political Behavior	0190-9320
Political Science Research and Methods	2049-8470	Policy Studies Journal	0190-292X	Perspectives on Politics	1537-5927
Socio-economic Review	1475-1461	Journal of Peace Research	0022-3433	Public Administration	0033-3298
Canadian Journal of Political Science	0008-4239	Public Opinion Quarterly	0033-362X	International Environmental Agreements: Politics, Law and Economics	1567-9764
Politics and Gender	1743-923X	International Studies Review	1521-9488	International Theory	1752-9719
South European Society and Politics	1360-8746	Ps - Political Science and Politics	1049-0965	East European Politics	2159-9165
Democratization	1351-0347	European Political Science Review	1755-7739	Journal of Democracy	1045-5736

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Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN
Journal of Politics	0022-3816	Journal of Conflict Resolution	0022-0027	Political Studies	0032-3217
Social Movement Studies	1474-2837	Regulation and Governance	1748-5983	Journal of European Integration	0703-6337
Geopolitics	1465-0045	Governance	0952-1895	African Affairs	0001-9909
Government and Opposition	0017-257X	Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science	0002-7162	Research and Politics	nan
Party Politics	1354-0688	Studies in Comparative International Development	0039-3606	International Studies Quarterly	0020-8833
Journal of Information Technology and Politics	1933-1681	Territory, Politics, Governance	2162-2671	Journal of Current Southeast Asian Affairs	1868-1034
International Political Sociology	1749-5679	Terrorism and Political Violence	0954-6553	Journal of Public Policy	0143-814X
Politics and Society	0032-3292	European Union Politics	1465-1165	Electoral Studies	0261-3794
Comparative Politics	0010-4159	Nations and Nationalism	1354-5078	Philosophy and Public Affairs	0048-3915
Politics and Governance	nan	International Political Science Review	0192-5121	Post-soviet Affairs	1060-586X
Journal of Common Market Studies	0021-9886	Political Research Quarterly	1065-9129	Swiss Political Science Review	1424-7755
Review of Policy Research	1541-132X	Cooperation and Conflict	0010-8367	European Political Science	1680-4333
Studies in Conflict and Terrorism	1057-610X	European Journal of Political Economy	0176-2680	Political Quarterly	0032-3179
Latin American Politics and Society	1531-426X	Political Studies Review	1478-9299	Global Policy	1758-5880
Journal of Strategic Studies	0140-2390	Social Science Quarterly	0038-4941	Local Government Studies	0300-3930
Journal of Human Rights	1475-4835	International Journal of Conflict and Violence	1864-1385	New Left Review	0028-6060
Politics	0263-3957	Contemporary Political Theory	1470-8914	Publius: the Journal of Federalism	0048-5950
Business and Politics	1469-3569	International Journal of Public Opinion Research	0954-2892	Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties	1745-7289
British Journal of Politics and International Relations	1369-1481	Citizenship Studies	1362-1025	Journal of Political Philosophy	0963-8016
Meditteranean Politics	1362-9395	Journal of International Relations and Development	1408-6980	Quarterly Journal of Political Science	1554-0626
Comparative European Politics	1472-4790	European Security	0966-2839	The International Journal of Transitional Justice	1752-7716
International Feminist Journal of Politics	1461-6742	Problems of Post-communism	1075-8216	Public Choice	0048-5829
Politics and Religion	nan	American Politics Research	1532-673X	Legislative Studies Quarterly	0362-9805
Europe-asia Studies	0966-8136	German Politics	0964-4008	International Politics	1384-5748
Armed Forces and Society	0095-327X	Political Theory	0090-5917	Review of African Political Economy	0305-6244
Journal of Contemporary European Studies	1478-2804	Scandinavian Political Studies	0080-6757	Ethics and International Affairs	0892-6794
Current History	0011-3530	International Affairs	0020-5850	Political Science	0032-3187
Intelligence and National Security	0268-4527	Nationalities Papers	0090-5992	Acta Politica	0001-6810
Parliamentary Affairs	0031-2290	Survival	0039-6338	Australian Journal of Political Science	1036-1146
Revista Brasileira De Politica Internacional	0034-7329	Journal of Women, Politics and Policy	1554-477X	British Politics	1746-918X
Scottish Journal of Political Economy	0036-9292	Polity	0032-3497	Japanese Journal of Political Science	1468-1099
Journal of Theoretical Politics	0951-6298	Economics and Politics	0954-1985	Human Rights Quarterly	0275-0392
Contemporary Southeast Asia	0129-797X	Politics, Philosophy and Economics	1470-594X	Communist and Post-communist Studies	0967-067X
Australian Journal of Politics and History	0004-9522	Presidential Studies Quarterly	0360-4918	Critical Review	0891-3811

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Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN
Political Science Quarterly	0032-3195	Studies in American Political Development	0898-588X	Forum (germany)	1540-8884
East European Politics and Societies	0888-3254	Latin American Perspectives	0094-582X	Irish Political Studies	0790-7184
Ethics and Global Politics	1654-4951	Historical Materialism	1465-4466	European History Quarterly	0265-6914
Politicka Ekonomie	0032-3233	Journal of Policy History	0898-0306	Telos	0090-6514
In Sample (Without Text)					
Annual Review of Political Science	1094-2939	Policy and Society	1449-4035	Policy and Politics	0305-5736
Journal of Chinese Governance	2381-2346	Contemporary Politics	1356-9775	Journal of Political Ideologies	1356-9317
International Security	0162-2889	Critical Policy Studies	1946-0171	State Politics and Policy Quarterly	1532-4400
Cambridge Review of International Affairs	0955-7571	Revista De Ciencia Politica	0716-1417	Peacebuilding	2164-7259
Politische Vierteljahresschrift	0032-3470	Monthly Review	0027-0520	Journal of Australian Political Economy	0156-5826
Politikon	0258-9346	Nation	0027-8378	Austrian Journal of Political Science	nan
Journal of Cold War Studies	1520-3972	Dissent	0012-3846	Politica Y Gobierno	1405-1060
Historia Y Politica	1575-0361	Lex Localis	1581-5374	Revista De Estudios Politicos	0048-7694
Independent Review	1086-1653	Internasjonal Politikk	0020-577X	Osteuropa	0030-6428
Politix	0295-2319	Romanian Journal of Political Science	1582-456X		
Out of Sample					
Earth System Governance	2589-8116	Chinese Political Science Review	2365-4244	Journal of Experimental Political Science	2052-2630
European Policy Analysis	nan	Journal of Genocide Research	1462-3528	Journal of Political Power	2158-379X
European Journal of Politics and Gender	2515-1088	Frontiers in Political Science	nan	Contemporary Italian Politics	2324-8823
Research & Politics	nan	World	nan	Journal of Political Marketing	1537-7857
Global Discourse	2326-9995	Political Research Exchange	nan	Politics Groups and Identities	2156-5503
Critical Studies on Security	2162-4887	Italian Political Science Review-rivista Italiana Di Scienza Politica	0048-8402	Regional and Federal Studies	1359-7566
African Security	1939-2206	Review of Economics and Political Science	2356-9980	Peace Economics Peace Science and Public Policy	1079-2457
Global Public Policy and Governance	2730-6291	Critical Studies on Terrorism	1753-9153	Journal of Politics in Latin America	1866-802X
Global Social Policy	1468-0181	State Crime	2046-6056	Business and Politics	nan
Politics & Policy	1555-5623	Studies in Social Justice	1911-4788	Interest Groups & Advocacy	2047-7414
Zeitschrift Fur Vergleichende Politikwissenschaft	1865-2646	Election Law Journal	1533-1296	Behavioral Sciences of Terrorism and Political Aggression	1943-4472
European Journal of Political Theory	1474-8851	Civil Wars	1369-8249	Ethnopolitics	1744-9057
Public Administration and Policy-an Asia-pacific Journal	1727-2645	Constellations-an International Journal of Critical and Democratic Theory	1351-0487	Journal of International Political Theory	1755-0882
Journal of Comparative Politics	1338-1385	East Asian Policy	1793-9305	Capital and Class	0309-8168
International Journal of Politics Culture and Society	0891-4486	Asian Journal of Comparative Politics	2057-8911	Asian Politics & Policy	1943-0779
Forum-a Journal of Applied Research in Contemporary Politics	2194-6183	New Perspectives	2336-825X	Moral Philosophy and Politics	2194-5616
Journal of Human Rights Practice	1757-9619	Partecipazione E Conflitto	1972-7623	Journal of Political Science Education	1551-2169

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Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN	Journal Title	ISSN
Critical Review of International Social and Political Philosophy	1369-8230	National Identities	1460-8944	Democratic Theory-an Interdisciplinary Journal	2332-8894
Global Constitutionalism	2045-3817	Global Responsibility to Protect	1875-9858	Issues & Studies	1013-2511
Colombia Internacional	0121-5612	Rethinking Marxism-a Journal of Economics Culture & Society	0893-5696	Revista Espanola De Ciencia Politica-recp	1575-6548
Latin American Policy	2041-7365	Democracy & Security	1741-9166	Teoria Y Realidad Constitucional	1139-5583
Politics Religion & Ideology	2156-7689	Polis-politicheskiye Issledovaniya	1026-9487	Journal of Civil Society	1744-8689
Global Change Peace & Security	1478-1158	Nordic Journal of Human Rights	1891-8131	Russian Politics	2451-8913
Rusi Journal	0307-1847	Socialist Studies	1918-2821	Revue D Economie Politique	0373-2630
Taltech Journal of European Studies	2674-4600	Asian Journal of Political Science	0218-5377	French Politics	1476-3419
Commonwealth & Comparative Politics	1466-2043	Politologicky Casopis-czech Journal of Political Science	1211-3247	Insight Turkey	1302-177X
Politica Y Sociedad	1130-8001	Caucasus Survey	2376-1199	Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice	2515-6918
Scottish Affairs	0966-0356	New Political Science	0739-3148	Intersections-east European Journal of Society and Politics	nan
China Quarterly of International Strategic Studies	2377-7400	Desafios	0124-4035	International Critical Thought	2159-8282
Geopoliticas-revista De Estudios Sobre Espacio Y Poder	2172-3958	Politicke Vedy	1335-2741	Politique Europeenne	1623-6297
Populism	2588-8064	Security and Human Rights	1874-7337	Otoritas-jurnal Ilmu Pemerintahan	2088-3706
Studia Europejskie-studies in European Affairs	1428-149X	Studies in Indian Politics	2321-0230	Obrana a Strategie-defence & Strategy	1214-6463
Strategic Review for Southern Africa	1013-1108	Urvio-revista Latinoamericana De Estudios De Seguridad	1390-3691	American Political Thought	2161-1580
Politeia-journal of Political Theory Political Philosophy and Sociology of Politics	2078-5089	Australasian Parliamentary Review	1447-9125	Idp-internet Law and Politics	1699-8154
Revista Brasileira De Estudos Politicos	0034-7191	Revista Internacional De Pensamiento Politico	1885-589X	International Journal of Cyber Warfare and Terrorism	1947-3435
America Latina Hoy-revista De Ciencias Sociales	1130-2887	Conflict Studies Quarterly	2285-7605	Revista De Investigaciones Politicas Y Sociologicas	1577-239X
Ciencia Politica	1909-230X	Reflexion Politica	0124-0781	Izquierdas	0718-5049
Canadian Political Science Review	1911-4125	New Proposals-journal of Marxism and Interdisciplinary Inquiry	1715-6718	Politicka Misao-croatian Political Science Review	0032-3241
Analele Universitatii Bucuresti-stiinte Politice	1582-2486	European Journal of Transformation Studies	2298-0997	Siyasal-journal of Political Sciences	nan
Icelandic Review of Politics & Administration	1670-6803	African Journal on Conflict Resolution	1562-6997	Revista Del Clad Reforma Y Democracia	1315-2378
Revista Estudios Socio-juridicos	0124-0579	Tocqueville Review	0730-479X	Scienza & Politica-per Una Storia Delle Dottrine	1590-4946
Analecta Politica	2027-7458	Temas Y Debates	1666-0714	Turkish Policy Quarterly	1303-5754
Anacronismo E Irrupcion	2250-4982	Cimexus	1870-6479	Ciudad Paz-ando	2011-5253
Pensamiento Al Margen	2386-6098	Revista Estudos Politicos	2177-2851	Sravnitelnaya Politika-comparative Politics	2221-3279
Revista Andina De Estudios Politicos	2221-4135	Politica & Societa	2240-7901	Revista Mexicana De Analisis Politico Y Administracion Publica	2007-4425
Storia Del Pensiero Politico	2279-9818	Totalitarismus Und Demokratie	1612-9008	Laboratoire Italien-politique Et Societe	1627-9204

Paper-level data

Using Scopus's metadata, we further extract information on all articles published in our sample. Scopus's metadata includes information on the article's authors, title, abstract, publication date, and DOI link. While informative, Scopus's article metadata is limited; for example, it does not tell much about the article's topic of inquiry, nor the method used or the identity of those commenting on papers along the way. We, therefore, supplemented Scopus's metadata by first downloading all articles that we were able to.[18] Specifically, we were able to successfully scrape the paper text of 111,854 articles. Armed with the full text of the articles, we classified each paper by topic using structure topic modeling (STM) and by method using a combination of Supervised Machine Learning and ChatGPT.

Author-level data

We identify 95,567 unique authors who wrote the articles published in the complete list of political science journals between 2003 and 2023 (85,654 unique authors in the filtered list of journals). Using Scopus's metadata, extracting information on these authors is relatively straightforward. Scopus metadata includes information on each author's yearly number of documents (i.e., publications), yearly citation count, and affiliation country. We supplement Scopus with measures of authors' gender, constructed using the genderize.io package,[19] as well as summary measures of publication success such as h-index and Euclid scores.

Commenter-level data

Given the importance of informal forms of collaboration, a key innovation of this study is assembling systematic information on those commenting on journal articles. Neither Scopus nor Clarivate collects this information. We construct our original dataset of commenters in three steps. First, we extracted the acknowledgment section, when such a section exists, from each of the 111,854 journal articles we scraped for a total of 77,101 acknowledgment sections. In the next step, we use GPT to extract the names of commenters for 63,522 articles with an acknowledgment section and names of commenters (1,579 articles had an acknowledgment section but did not thank anyone as a commenter). This stage left us with the names of 105,008 unique commenters. In the third step, we matched the commenters' names, as extracted directly from the acknowledgment section, back to Scopus's metadata using a fuzzy match algorithm. Notably, only 66,967 commenters (or 64% of named commenters) have a Scopus ID. In such cases, we constructed a dataset with similar metadata information on authors (e.g., number of yearly publications and citations, h-index, and

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[18]We were unable to scrape certain articles due to limited institutional access or technical barriers on publisher websites.

[19]The *genderize.io* package predicts binary gender based on the frequency of first names (and country when available) in a labeled dataset of over one billion public social media profiles. We were able to assign gender for $\approx 97\%$ of authors, with a mean posterior probability of 96.8%.

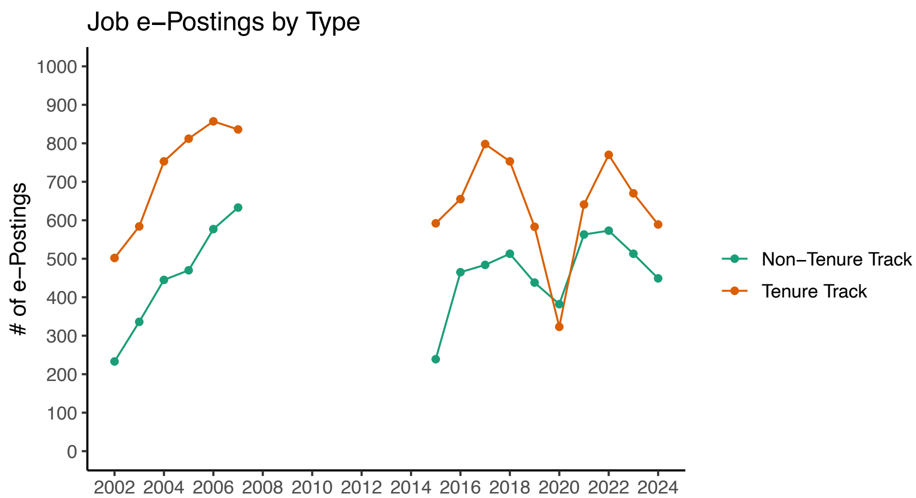

Figure C1: Figure shows the total number of postings on the APSA eJobs site per year, according whether the jobs advertised tenure track (in orange), non-tenure track (in green), or the total number (in purple). APSA did not have data from 2008-2014 available in comparable format.

Euclid scores.) This information does not exist for the 36% of commenters we could not match to a recognizable scholar.

C The PS Job Market

In this paper, we argue that structural shifts in the discipline, including a tightening job market relative to an expanding supply of candidates, shape the strategic incentives of political science researchers. Figure C1 provides empirical support for this claim using data from the APSA eJobs website, the most comprehensive source of information on the job market. While academic positions had rebounded to pre-pandemic levels in 2024, the future of the 2025 job market remains uncertain amid institutional budget cuts and hiring freezes. Even at the current rate of approximately 1,100 new positions annually —with only 600-700 being tenure-track—the discipline faces significant oversupply. This imbalance is particularly striking when we consider that in 2014 alone, approximately 3,000 new authors entered the field, with that number continuing to grow. By 2023, the discipline included approximately 15,000 authors publishing in a single year.

An alternative measure of demand for TT positions is the Survey of Earned Doctorates, an annual census of research doctorate recipients from US academic institutions. We compare the number of graduating PhDs in political science or public policy to TT positions, as advertised on APSA's eJobs site in Figure C4. Using these data, we estimate a rate of between 1.3-3 new PhDs in political science or policy per tenure-track position (as per APSA eJobs listings). However, this likely represents a stark underestimation since the SED excludes graduates of foreign institutions, ABD candidates who comprise a substantial portion of job market participants, and it limits the demand to within-field graduates, ignoring cross-field competition for the same political science

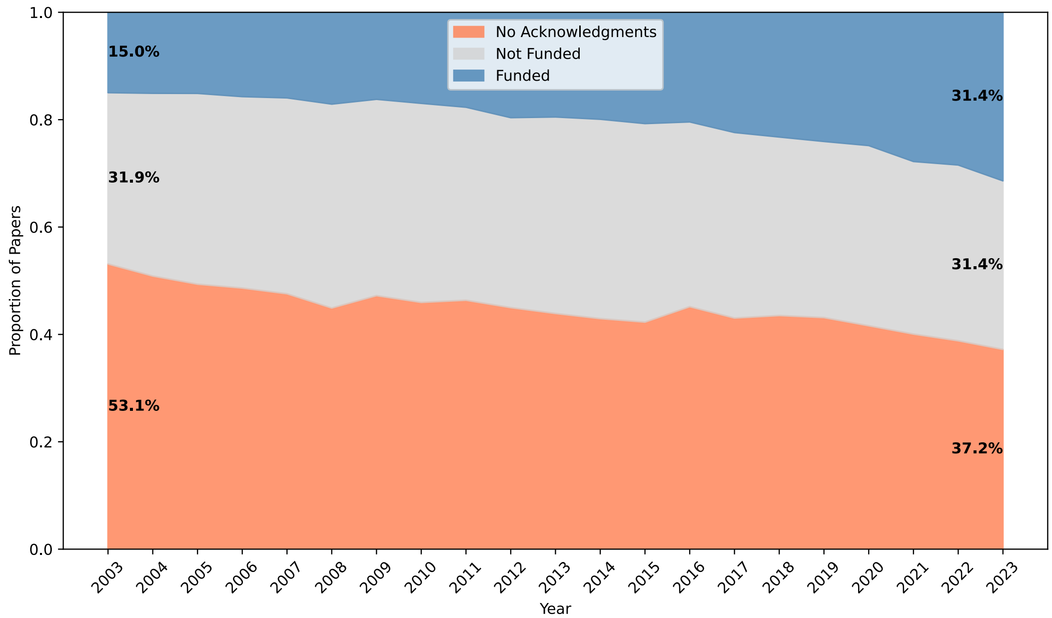

Figure C2: Figure shows the proportion of papers with at least one funding source mentioned in the acknowledgments section. From 2003 to 2023, among those papers with an acknowledgment section, the proportion of funded papers more than doubled, from 15% to 31.4%.

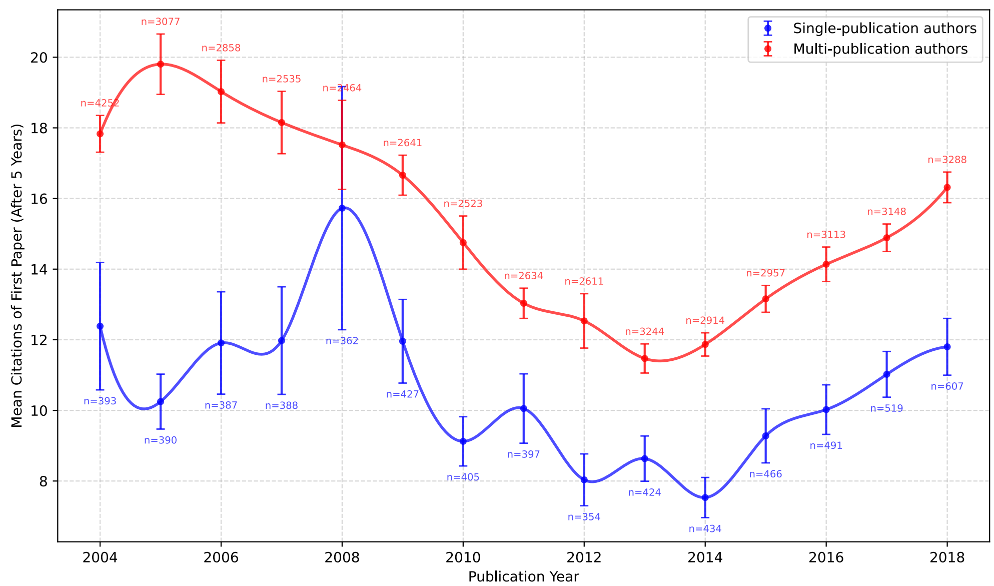

Figure C3: Figure shows the mean number of citations for each author-paper, only if it is an author's first paper, five years after the paper's publication year. The blue line represents authors who will never publish again after that first paper, the red line represents authors who will.

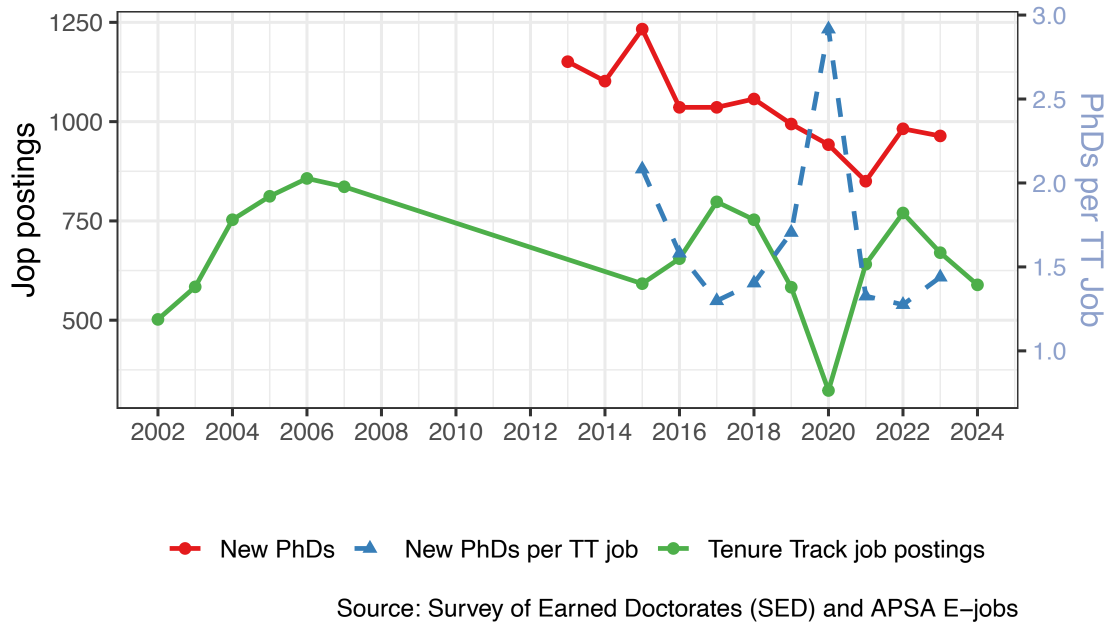

Figure C4: Green line shows the number of job postings for tenure track positions, as advertised on APSA's eJobs. Red line shows the yearly number of graduating PhDs in political science of public policy from US institutions as reported in the Survey of Earned Doctorates. The dashed blue line shows the ratio of graduating PhDs per TT job each year.

positions.

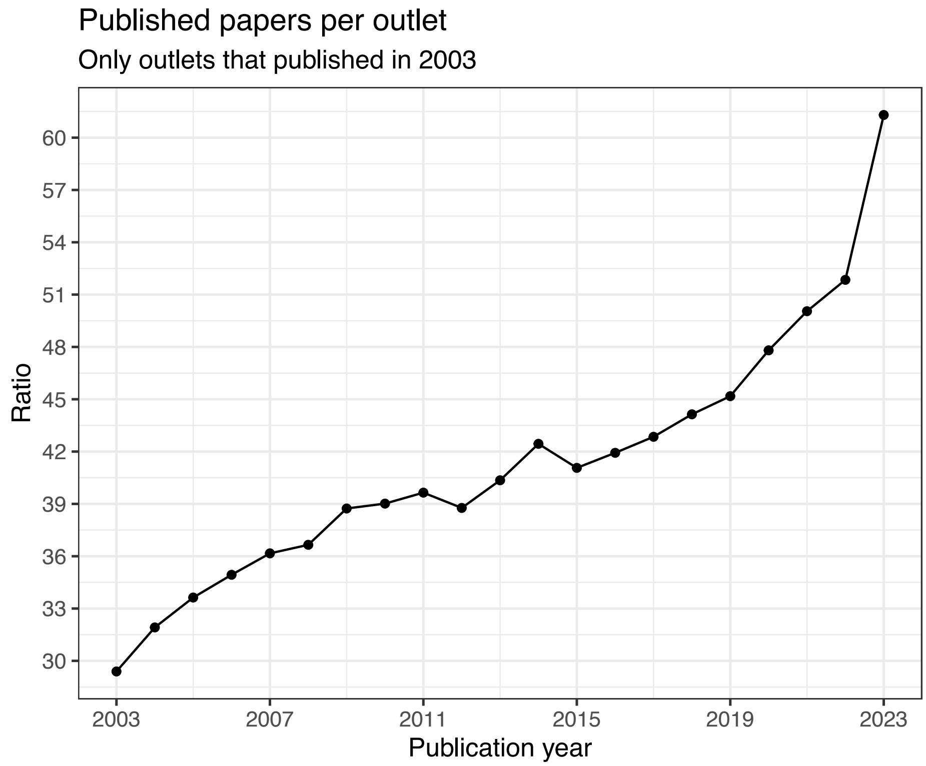

Figure D5: Figure shows the ratio of published papers over publishing outlets per year, for papers published in outlets that were already existent in 2003.

D Volume

In Figure 2, we show that the rate of published papers per outlet is consistently increasing. This could be the result of (a) existing journals publishing more paper per issue or (b) new journals publishing more paper per issue from their inception. In Figure D5, we replicate the right panel of Figure 2 but subletting the data only to journals which were already publishing in 2003. Even after reducing the sample, we can see the same trend in the number of published papers per outlet, suggesting that existing journals became more voluminous.

In the middle panel of Figure 2, we show that the number of publishing outlets increases during our study period, plateauing in recent years. A potential concern is that this growth reflects changes in sample composition rather than genuine disciplinary expansion. Specifically, existing journals might have crossed the SJR ≥ 1 threshold in recent years, creating spurious growth through indexing expansion rather than new outlet creation.

This explanation is unlikely given our methodology. We include all journals meeting the SJR ≥ 1 criterion in 2022 retrospectively—that is, we include their complete publication histories regardless of their rankings in previous years. However, concerns might remain that mechanical changes in measurement or indexing practices could artificially inflate outlet counts.

To address these concerns, we examine the founding dates of journals in our sample. Figure

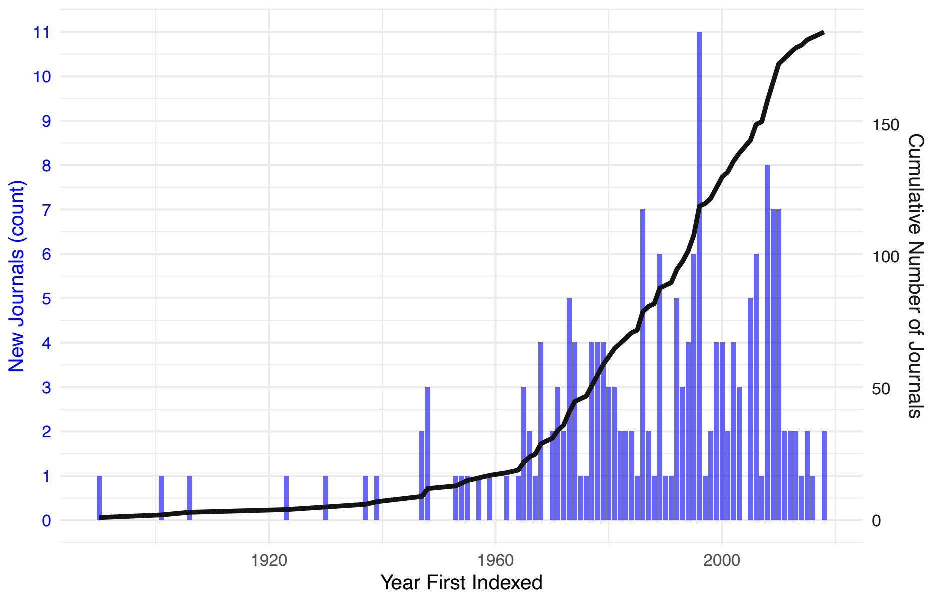

Figure D6: Cumulative number of journals by founding year (gray line) and annual count of newly founded journals (blue bars), based on reported first publication dates from Scopus metadata.

D6 displays both the cumulative count of journals by year of first publication (gray line) and the annual number of newly founded journals (blue bars). The temporal distribution spans from 1890 to 2018, with clear acceleration in recent decades. The pattern shows genuine outlet proliferation: few journals predate 1950, growth accelerates through the 1970s–1990s, and new journal creation peaks in the 2000s before recent moderation. This founding pattern demonstrates that observed growth reflects actual disciplinary expansion rather than indexing artifacts, as journals created across more than a century are represented in our sample.

E Productivity

F Topics (STM)

To discover and extract thematic and semantic structures embedded in each paper, we fit Structural Topic Model (STM) (Roberts et al. 2013) to the first 1000 words of each paper. Topic modeling approaches such as Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) (Blei, Ng and Jordan 2003) and the Correlated Topic Model (CTM) (Blei and Lafferty 2007) has been widely used in the field of social sciences and political sciences. Topic models is a generative model that defines the data generating process to be the following: each document (paper) first draws topics from a document-topic distribution, then conditional on the chosen topics, each word is again draw from a topic-word distribution to construct a full document. The input of a topic model is a document-term matrix

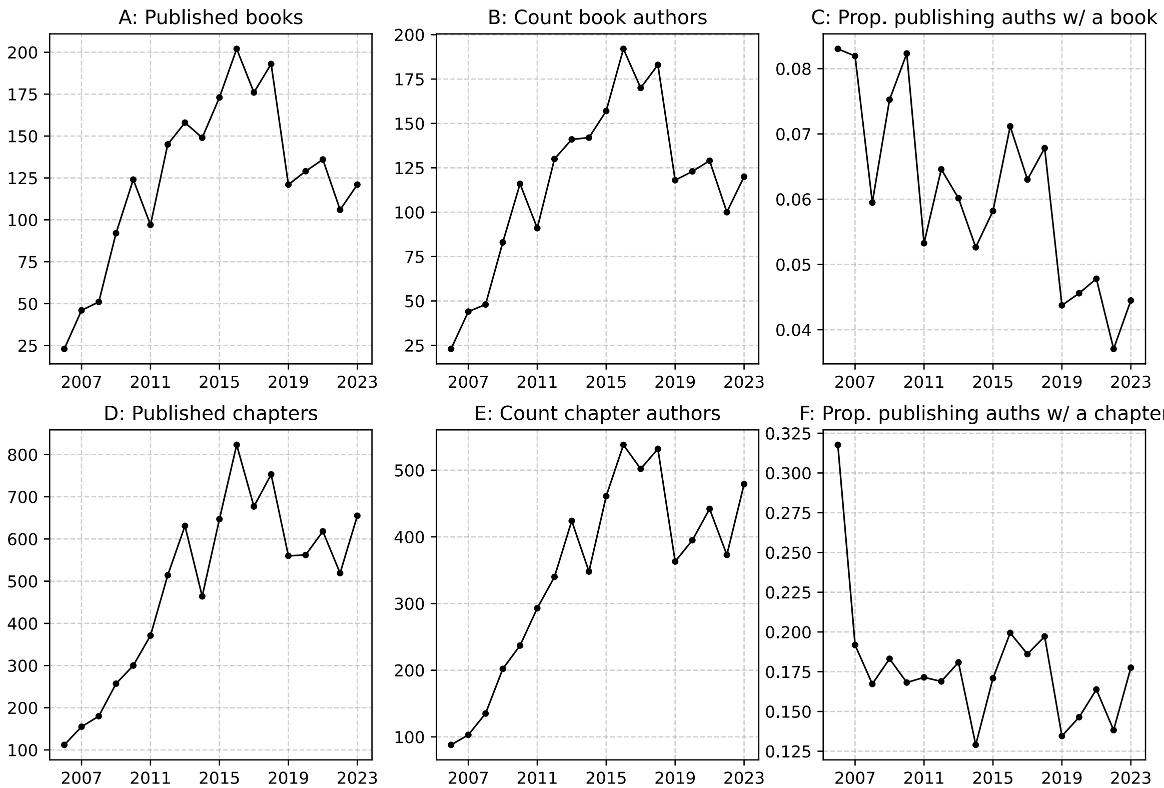

Figure E7: This figure shows book and book chapter publications for active political science authors in our sample (defined as those who published at least 5 papers from 2003-2023, with 50% of those papers in political science journals). Panels A and D show count of books and book chapters published each year. Panels B and E show the count of unique authors who published books and book chapters each year. Panels C and F show the proportion of authors who published books and chapters over the number of authors who published anything in political science that year or prior to that year.

where each document is represented by its unique compositing words and their frequency. The model uses variational inference to estimate parameters upon convergence. Final outputs include a list of identified topics, the posterior proportion of each document allocated to each topic, and the posterior probability distribution of words associated with respective topic.

Compared to these traditional topic modeling methods, we prefer STM because it allows researchers to incorporate document attributes or metadata into the topic modeling. In this case, either topical prevalence or topical content, or both, can be modeled as a function of the document-specific covariates. Topical prevalence impact the document-topic distribution whereas topical content refers to topic-word distribution. Our STM was estimated with publication year and journal placement as prevalence covariates, allowing the proportion of topics allocated to paper to vary across years and journals.

Since STM is an unsupervised learning process, the number of topics needs to be specified by researchers. We selected the model with 30 topics after carefully investigating topic interpretations with specifying the number of topics being 10, 20, 25, 30, 40, or 50. We present the first 10 highest frequency words for each topic, along with our manually created names in Table F3.

Table F3: Names & Top 10 Words Per STM Topic

Topic Name	**Top 10 Words (lemmatized)**
1 - Electoral Institutions	*elect, vote, voter, candid, elector, parti, campaign, turnout, incumb, system, presidenti, democrat, seat, district, poll, result, effect, ballot, win, support*
2 - Quantitative Methods	*data, model, use, measur, analysi, differ, variabl, estim, effect, method, compar, number, empir, result, two, approach, time, test, set, case*
3 - Ethnic, Religious, and National Identity	*nation, ident, ethnic, religi, citizenship, cultur, religion, state, minor, group, polit, communiti, muslim, languag, islam, memori, church, nationalist, peopl, christian*
4 - Federalism and Decentralization	*local, region, state, govern, nation, feder, level, polit, territori, citi, system, urban, central, municip, parti, decentr, subnat, area, rural, differ*
5 - Democracy and Autocracy	*democraci, regim, polit, democrat, institut, state, authoritarian, power, countri, elit, reform, rule, transit, govern, latin, leader, opposit, econom, system, chang*
6 - Political Communication	*media, news, polit, communic, polar, inform, internet, digit, onlin, public, coverag, social, content, mass, technolog, platform, audienc, televis, frame, discuss*
7 - Financial and Labor Markets	*econom, market, economi, capit, bank, industri, labor, growth, busi, sector, financial, product, financi, invest, crisi, rate, worker, privat, labour, employ*

Table F3: Names & Top 10 Words Per STM Topic

Topic Name	**Top 10 Words (lemmatized)**
8 - Political Culture	*social, group, differ, polit, trust, individu, attitud, support, cultur, result, factor, countri, prefer, econom, level, valu, analysi, toward, import, determin*
9 - Post-Soviet Politics	*russia, russian, soviet, ukrain, communist, ukrainian, eastern, war, putin, europ, region, moscow, union, countri, republ, west, foreign, western, polici, postcommunist*
10 - Law, Human Rights, and Courts	*right, law, human, state, legal, court, intern, justic, constitut, protect, rule, case, enforc, norm, polic, crime, govern, crimin, violat, judici*
11 - Gender and LGBTQI+	*women, gender, men, femal, feminist, sexual, polit, male, equal, represent, quota, differ, sex, marriag, role, publish, gap, experi, intersect, masculin*
12 - Terrorism	*terror, intellig, terrorist, attack, australian, australia, group, ireland, secur, cite, northern, british, threat, radic, govern, irish, activ, oper, term, suicid*
13 - US Presidency	*american, presid, time, polit, year, mani, govern, public, press, peopl, nation, histori, end, made, publish, day, unit, like, british, earli*
14 - Critical Theory	*social, polit, concept, theori, practic, cultur, relat, discours, world, idea, way, histor, histori, critic, approach, form, develop, narrat, mean, modern*
15 - Environmental Politics	*polici, chang, govern, environment, institut, climat, actor, develop, process, global, approach, focus, intern, problem, energi, framework, system, environ, state, policymak*
16 - Coalition Formation and Party Systems	*parti, polit, govern, coalit, system, parliamentari, posit, ideolog, parliament, elector, populist, polici, minist, leader, right, support, issu, left, chang, elect*
17 - Social Movements	*movement, organ, social, network, protest, mobil, activ, group, societi, civil, activist, action, collect, polit, stakehold, relationship, interest, structur, transnat, sport*
18 - Indigenous Politics	*indigen, land, des, les, canadian, que, canada, food, los, las, politiqu, mexico, latin, del, sur, dan, agricultur, con, est, para*
19 - Bureaucratic Politics	*public, govern, servic, agenc, administr, manag, organ, inform, health, perform, provid, student, program, privat, respons, bureaucrat, sector, organiz, develop, implement*
20 - Lobbying and Interest Groups	*legisl, polici, presid, group, member, interest, state, congress, committe, execut, power, senat, decis, hous, legislatur, major, court, presidenti, prefer, polit*

Table F3: Names & Top 10 Words Per STM Topic

Topic Name	**Top 10 Words (lemmatized)**
21 - Global Trade	*china, countri, trade, develop, global, econom, world, africa, chines, south, aid, intern, region, african, nation, asia, foreign, oil, japan, govern*
22 - Public Opinion and Political Psychology	*survey, public, polit, opinion, effect, respond, attitud, support, inform, individu, behavior, experi, respons, like, peopl, percept, affect, question, evalu, find*
23 - Security Studies	*intern, state, secur, power, foreign, polici, relat, nuclear, war, unit, global, domest, world, threat, strateg, nation, cooper, order, strategi, interest*
24 - European Politics	*european, polici, union, member, integr, state, nation, europ, countri, institut, commiss, govern, crisi, germani, process, council, actor, negoti, level, polit*
25 - Normative Theory	*moral, theori, liber, reason, human, argument, individu, claim, peopl, polit, principl, right, valu, argu, way, view, ethic, good, justic, equal*
26 - Race and Immigration Politics	*educ, immigr, social, state, racial, american, black, famili, school, welfar, popul, white, children, migrat, polici, health, migrant, increas, percent, age*
27 - War	*militari, war, forc, iraq, oper, arm, armi, civilian, israel, arab, unit, afghanistan, soldier, secur, iran, defens, support, isra, state, pakistan*
28 - Civil War and Intergroup Conflict	*iolenc, conflict, war, peac, group, conflict, civil, state, violent, arm, rebel, intern, like, actor, govern, polit, effect, increas, support, victim*
29 - Fiscal Politics, Inequality, and Redistribution	*govern, cost, polici, econom, tax, effect, model, public, countri, corrupt, spend, incom, increas, good, literatur, prefer, result, incent, polit, level*
30 - Representation and Accountability	*polit, citizen, democraci, particip, democrat, public, institut, repres, process, govern, interest, legitimaci, represent, engag, system, peopl, account, civic, decis, deliber*

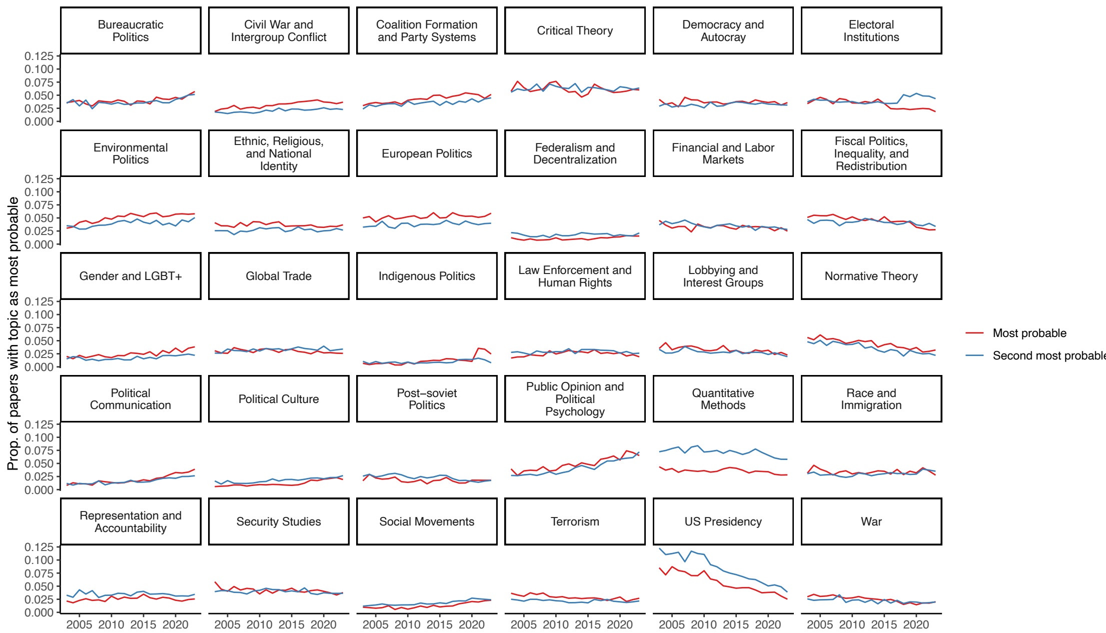

Figure F8: Figure shows the proportion of yearly papers for which the STM model estimates each topic as the most probable (in red) and for which the STM model estimates each topic as the second most probable (in blue).

Topic rank	Mean Prob.	SD Prob.	Min Prob.	Max Prob.	Median Prob.
1	0.410	0.156	0.096	0.999	0.377
2	0.199	0.069	0.0004	0.491	0.196
3	0.120	0.048	0.0002	0.306	0.119
4	0.077	0.035	0.0001	0.222	0.076
5	0.052	0.027	0.0001	0.172	0.050

Table F4: Descriptive statistics of posterior topic proportion, for the five most likely topics per paper.

topic	count	quant	qual	formal	normative
Bureaucratic Politics	4592	0.57	0.32	0.01	0.10
Civil War and Intergroup Conflict	3644	0.63	0.31	0.02	0.03
Coalition Formation and Party Systems	4978	0.71	0.25	0.02	0.02
Critical Theory	6779	0.15	0.36	0.01	0.49
Democracy and Autocray	4094	0.48	0.45	0.01	0.06
Electoral Institutions	3460	0.91	0.05	0.03	0.01
Environmental Politics	5816	0.33	0.51	0.02	0.15
Ethnic, Religious, and National Identity	4054	0.28	0.59	0.00	0.12
European Politics	5899	0.41	0.47	0.01	0.10
Federalism and Decentralization	1275	0.63	0.30	0.01	0.06
Financial and Labor Markets	3560	0.47	0.38	0.03	0.12
Fiscal Politics, Inequality, and Redistribution	4787	0.72	0.06	0.18	0.04
Gender and LGBT+	2921	0.57	0.34	0.00	0.09
Global Trade	3277	0.39	0.51	0.01	0.09
Indigenous Politics	1580	0.35	0.52	0.01	0.12
Law Enforcement and Human Rights	2791	0.46	0.32	0.01	0.21
Lobbying and Interest Groups	3507	0.82	0.11	0.04	0.03
Normative Theory	4680	0.11	0.05	0.01	0.82
Political Communication	2368	0.80	0.15	0.01	0.04
Political Culture	1452	0.95	0.04	0.00	0.01
Post-soviet Politics	1968	0.50	0.45	0.00	0.03
Public Opinion and Political Psychology	5784	0.97	0.02	0.00	0.00
Quantitative Methods	3888	0.86	0.07	0.03	0.04
Race and Immigration	3770	0.69	0.27	0.00	0.04
Representation and Accountability	2862	0.59	0.19	0.00	0.21
Security Studies	4589	0.36	0.38	0.02	0.23
Social Movements	1549	0.42	0.54	0.00	0.03
Terrorism	3137	0.48	0.42	0.02	0.08
US Presidency	5860	0.19	0.55	0.00	0.26
War	2639	0.25	0.59	0.01	0.15

Table F5: Method proportions by topic (for papers where the topic is the most likely topic)

Count of Topics with $P(\theta_t) \geq .1$	Number of Papers	Prop. of Papers	Cumulative Prop. of Papers
0	1	0.00	0.00
1	7,497	6.72	6.72
2	30,220	27.09	33.81
3	44,925	40.27	74.08
4	23,789	21.32	95.40
5	4,794	4.30	99.70
6	332	0.30	99.99
7	2	0.00	100.00

Table F6: Count and proportion of papers in the sample, according to the number of topics for which the STM estimates a posterior probability higher than $.1$.

G Method Classification

Overall Methods

We thus classified each paper by its method. After cleaning the full text and removing stop-words, we leverage a sample of papers manually coded by Teele and Thelen (2017) that overlaps with our sample to train our classification model. We begin with three labels: quantitative, qualitative/normative, and formal. In stage one, we train a TF-IDF + Logistic Regression model to identify key features (i.e., words), then proceed to a second stage using only the top 50 features to reduce noise.[20] Next, to distinguish between qualitative/normative papers, we utilize ChatGPT along with a custom prompt.[21] Measuring these results against Teele and Thelen and additional papers from the TRIP Journal Article Database (*TRIP Journal Article Database Release (Version 3.3).* 2020; Maliniak and Tierney 2018), we achieve an F1 score of 88%. With the model and prompt together, we classified the papers in our sample into four categories: quantitative, qualitative, normative, and formal.

To classify papers with available full-texts into methods: quant, qual/normative, formal, we use the following procedure.

- First, we clean and prepare the raw text of the paper by: a) removing any preamble before the abstract and the bibliography, b) text cleaning including removing white space, removing lines with fewer than 5 words, and removing lines with less than 50% text characters, c) and removing stopwords from the text using The Natural Language Toolkit (NLTK) Python library's preset list of English stopwords as well as a custom set of stopwords.

- Second, we prepare a sample of papers manually coded by Teele and Thelen (2017) that overlaps with our own sample to use in training our classification model. Teele and Thelen classified 1,694 papers in our full-text sample into six categories: statistical (1,138), experiment (145), qualitative (140), formal theory (118), political theory (105), and conceptual (48), which we consolidated into our three categories: quant (1283), qual/normative (293), formal (118).

- Third, we use this corpus of text to train two stage classifier using the Scikit-learn Python ML library. In the first stage, we vectorize the text with TfidfVectorizer, then use a OneVsRestClassifier alongside a LogisticRegression to fit one classifier per class. Initially, we limit

[20]We achieve a mean macro F1 score of 82% (+/- 0.06) across a cross-fold validation test. For example, here are some representative words and their corresponding classification coefficients for each category: Quantitative — equilibrium (-3.9); variables (2.9); results (2.8). Formal — equilibrium (5.6); model (2.5); game (1.9). Qualitative/Normative — model (-2.7); variable (-2.2); justice (1.8). A full classification report and a list of coefficients can be seen in the appendix under Tables G7 and G8.

[21]The prompt text and performance is available in the Appendix under Prompt 1 and Table G9.

the vocabulary of the model to 450 features, including both unigrams (single words) and bigrams (two consecutive words). In stage two, we take the 70 most significant features from the initial classifiers and retrain a model with this limited vocabulary to reduce noise in the text features (a list of the top 40 features, along with their respective coefficients can be seen in Table G8). All parameters were optimized using GridSearchCV.

- Fourth, after evaluating performance of the model with a 10 fold cross validation, (see results in Table G7) we train a final classifier on the entire labeled corpus and use it to classify our entire sample.

Although we initially classified our sample into three categories, quant, qual/normative, and formal, we wanted to distinguish between qualitative and normative papers. After achieving poor results on this task using a Logistic Regression, we resorted to the use of OpenAI's GPT-4o-Mini large language model alongside a custom prompt (see Prompt 1) to classify these papers. Specifically, we fed GPT the title, abstract, and first 2,000 characters of each paper previously classified as "qual/normative". Ultimately, this left us with the papers in our sample classified into four final categories: quantitative, qualitative, normative, and formal.

To evaluate the performance of GPT, we again used the manually coded sample from Teele and Thelen (2017), but added to this labeled data by a) taking papers from the journals *International Theory*, *Journal of Political Philosophy*, *Philosophy and Public Affairs*, *Contemporary Political Theory*, *Political Theory*, *Journal of Political Philosophy* on the assumption that they were normative, and b) adding additional papers labeled as qualitative from the TRIP Journal Article Database (*TRIP Journal Article Database Release (Version 3.3).* 2020; Maliniak and Tierney 2018). In total, the resulted in a test set with 2,149 papers labeled as normative, and 422 papers labeled as qualitative. The results of the classification are shown in Table G9.

Category	Precision	Recall	F1-score	Support
Quantitative	0.93	0.96	0.95	1283
Formal	0.88	0.65	0.75	118
Qual/Theory	0.85	0.81	0.83	293
Micro avg	0.92	0.92	0.92	1694
Macro avg	0.88	0.81	0.84	1694
Weighted avg	0.91	0.92	0.91	1694
Samples avg	0.92	0.92	0.92	1694

Table G7: LogReg Method Classification Report

Quant		Formal		Qual/Norm	
equilibrium	-3.89	equilibrium	5.57	model	-2.66
variables	2.91	model	2.53	results	-2.56
results	2.86	game	1.93	effect	-2.42
variable	2.83	bargaining	1.79	variable	-2.30
data	2.57	cost	1.78	variables	-2.19
effect	2.38	data	-1.52	justice	1.77
respondents	2.11	political	-1.41	social	1.76
likely	2.09	probability	1.30	interests	1.73
case	-1.98	variables	-1.28	data	-1.73
table	1.94	rule	1.09	new	1.67
attitudes	1.77	variable	-1.05	causal	1.63
effects	1.73	respondents	-1.02	respondents	-1.62
sample	1.72	war	1.01	good	1.59
good	-1.64	significant	-1.00	likely	-1.58
new	-1.62	subjects	-0.97	attitudes	-1.55
example	-1.59	democratic	-0.96	did	1.54
social	-1.57	table	-0.94	probability	-1.49
measure	1.51	effects	-0.93	theory	1.42
causal	-1.50	case	0.93	equilibrium	-1.42
cost	-1.44	type	0.90	table	-1.41
using	1.43	public	-0.90	sample	-1.40
subjects	1.39	network	0.88	people	1.39
strategy	-1.37	results	-0.88	way	1.38
justice	-1.36	target	0.87	human	1.38
estimates	1.36	control	-0.85	effects	-1.35
ndings	1.31	treatment	-0.84	like	1.32
statistically	1.28	beliefs	0.82	liberal	1.28
interests	-1.27	strategy	0.82	state	1.25
way	-1.26	lower	0.81	society	1.22
signicant	1.26	people	-0.80	power	1.22
significant	1.24	equation	0.78	market	1.20
theory	-1.23	result	0.76	organizations	1.19
impact	1.22	elections	-0.76	example	1.19
rule	-1.19	investment	0.76	reform	1.19
levels	1.16	women	-0.76	view	1.17
make	-1.15	partisan	-0.75	law	1.16
panel	1.14	terrorist	0.74	scholars	1.16
year	1.14	using	-0.74	crisis	1.16
problem	-1.13	estimates	-0.74	problem	1.15
private	-1.12	median	0.73	case	1.15

Table G8: Top 40 words by classification coefficient for each method category

Prompt 1: Qualitative v. Normative GPT Prompt

```
<!--begin excerpt-->
Title: {TITLE}
Abstract: {ABSTRACT}
FIRST_2000_CHARS: {FIRST_2000_CHARS}
<!--end excerpt-->
Your task is to analyze the above excerpts from a political science paper. After reading them carefully, you should construct a block of json metadata for the paper according to the following guidelines:
- **paperType**: Determine if this is a "normative" paper or a "qualitative" (empirical) paper.
  - **normative** indicates the paper is primarily focused on theoretical frameworks, moral or ethical arguments, prescriptive claims, or conceptual innovations without reliance on empirical data or case studies.
  - **qualitative** indicates an empirical (data-driven) study, which may include interviews, case studies, comparative analysis, content analysis, historical data, or meta-reviews of existing literature.

### Guidelines for Classification
1. **Normative (pure theory / moral arguments)**
   - Papers that primarily develop or critique theories, concepts, or frameworks in a philosophical or moral sense.
   - They often involve ethical, moral, legal, or cultural judgments about right and wrong, good and bad, or appropriate and inappropriate.
   - They may pose 'what ought to be' questions, emphasize values or justice, or propose normative principles, prescribing what should be done or believed.
   - They usually rely on logic, reasoned argumentation, and conceptual analysis rather than data collection, interviews, or observational findings.
2. **Qualitative (empirical)**
   - Research designed to make descriptive or explanatory inferences based on empirical information about the world, descriptive or explanatory (connecting causes and effects) in nature
   - Papers that draw on real-world data, case analyses, interviews, focus groups, participant observation, archival research, ethnography, historical narratives, content and thematic analysis, or other forms of empirical research
   - They may investigate political phenomena, test theories using specific evidence, or compare policy outcomes in different contexts.
   - Even if the paper references theories, the focus is on evidence-based conclusions, case studies, or empirical findings. Meta-
```

```
  reviews also fall under this category if they synthesize existing
  empirical studies.

### Special Considerations
- A paper can reference normative elements (e.g., an ethical
framework) while still featuring extensive empirical analysis. If the
 primary emphasis is on data or real-world evidence, classify as **
qualitative**.
- A paper can reference empirical examples as background, but if the
central argument is a moral or theoretical proposition with minimal
systematic evidence, classify as **normative**.
- Focus on the paper's overall purpose, tone, and evidence usage to
make your final classification.
Output your response as valid json in the following structure (with
very short sentence justification stored in a **justification**
variable if needed if needed in nuanced cases):
```

Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Support
isQualitative	0.74	0.87	0.80	422
isNormative	0.97	0.94	0.96	2149
Accuracy		0.93		2571
Macro Avg	0.85	0.90	0.88	2571
Weighted Avg	0.93	0.93	0.93	2571

Table G9: Qualitative v. Normative Classification Report

Prompt 2: Prompt For Checking Submeths True Positives

```
<!--begin excerpt-->
Predicted Method: {PREDICTED_METHOD}, {PREDICTED_METHOD_DESCRIPTION}
================
Paper Abstract:
{ABSTRACT}
================
Excerpts & Keywords:
{EXCERPTS_1000_CHARS}

<!--end excerpt-->
Your goal is to analyze the excerpts above and determine whether the paper under discussion genuinely applies the predicted method ({PREDICTED_METHOD}) in its research design, or whether it merely references the method in passing (for example, citing other papers that used it or explaining why the authors themselves did not adopt it). The decision hinges on explicit or implied language indicating the actual use of the method for data collection or analysis.

Guidelines for Determination
Method is Actually Used
- The paper explicitly states it employs this method in collecting or analyzing data.
- The excerpt points to direct application: e.g., "we conducted an RDD study using ..." or "the analysis follows a Diff-in-Diff approach ..."
- Clear mention of how data or evidence is gathered or processed with the specified method.

Method is Not Used (Only Referenced or Rejected)
- The excerpt indicates the authors are describing or critiquing how others have used the method, without applying it themselves.
- The authors mention the method as a possibility but ultimately report not implementing it.
- Discussion focuses on theoretical explanations of the method or historical references rather than application.

Output the response as valid JSON. Incorporate a short justification in a "justification" field only if needed to clarify the decision. The structure should be:

{"methodConfirmed": "Used" or "Not_Used", "justification": "... short note if needed ..."}
```

H Focus & Novelty

H.1 Index Construction

In this section, we explain how the topical focus and topical novelty indices are constructed using the STM output.

Focus Index

To measure the degree to which a paper is topically focused, we use the STM estimated proportion $\theta_{i,t}$ of each topic t in a given paper i. We then square these proportions, $\theta_{i,t}^2$, and sum the squared values for each paper. The resulting focus index is given by:

$$\text{Focus Index}_i = \sum_t \theta_{i,t}^2$$

Higher values indicate a greater concentration on fewer topics.

Novelty Index

To assess how novel a paper's topic combination is, we first identify the two most prevalent topics in each paper according to the STM output. Next, we define three-year rolling windows and count the total number of papers published on each topic within each rolling window. Using these counts, we determine the total number of papers published on each topic within the window.

To estimate how many papers would be expected to contain the identified topic combination by chance, we use the following formula:

$$E(T_a, T_b) = \frac{N_a \times N_b}{N_{\text{total}}}$$

where N_a is the number of papers on Topic a in the window, N_b is the number of papers on Topic b in the window, N_{total} is the total number of papers published in the window, and $E(T_a, T_b)$ represents the expected number of papers that contain both topics by chance.

For example, if 10 papers were published on Topic 1, 20 on Topic 2, and 100 papers in total within a three-year window, the expected number of papers containing both topics by chance is:

$$E(T_1, T_2) = \frac{10 \times 20}{100} = 2$$

The ratio of the actual number of observed papers with the topic combination to the expected number is computed as:

$$R(T_a, T_b) = \frac{O(T_a, T_b)}{E(T_a, T_b)}$$

where $O(T_a, T_b)$ is the observed number of papers with the topic combination. Finally, the novelty index is calculated as:

$$\text{Novelty Index} = 1 - R(T_a, T_b)$$

A higher novelty score indicates that a paper's topic combination is less common than expected by chance, relative to the last three years of publications.

Focus, Novelty, and Paper-Level Performance

In Table 3 we show that topical focus and topical novelty are systematically related to higher citations, relative to other papers published in the same year and the same journal. We further show there is not systematic relationship between novelty and the probability that a paper is published in a Top 20 outlet. In the following Table (Table H10), we estimate the association between focus, novelty, and a paper's citations. However, we compare paper-level citations with those of other papers published in the same year, regardless of the outlet where they were published (by standardizing the citation count within year). Results for topical focus are consistent in magnitude and positive, suggesting focus is positively associated with paper-level performance overall. However, results for novelty are estimated to be precisely zero. These results suggest that while, relative to other papers published that year and in the same outlet, more novel papers get more citations after accounting for authors' quality, it is not the case that relative to other papers published that year overall, more novel papers get more citations, after accounting for authors' quality.

	Citations (year-std)	Top 20	Citations (year-std)	Top 20
Novelty	0.000	0.002		
	(0.006)	(0.002)		
Focus			0.059***	0.002
			(0.010)	(0.003)
Author FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Num.Obs.	166 387	166 387	166 387	166 387
R2	0.419	0.542	0.461	0.542

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Table H10: Table shows the estimated change in paper citations (standardized within year) when a paper's novelty or focus index and the estimated change in the probability that paper i is published in a Top 20 outlet (as per their SJR Impact ranking, see Table B1 in the Appendix for details.). Robust standard errors, clustered at the author and paper level, reported in parentheses.

Team Composition and Novelty

In Figure 9 we show that all female teams produce the most novel research. In this section we probe deeper into this result. In Figure H.1 we plot the proportion of papers published by teams, according to their gender composition, that have each topic as one of their two most common topics. Topics are arranged from largest difference between all-male and all-female teams to smallest. As can be seen, all female teams publish most often on Critical Theory, followed by Gender and LGBT+. In contrast, all male teams publish most frequently in Critical Theory, Quantitative Methods, and Security Studies. Mixed gender teams most often write papers about Public Opinion and Political Psychology.

In the main paper, we find that novelty is positively associated with paper-level success, measured as the standardized number of citations within a journal-year, but not when citations are standardized within years. We argue, based on extant literature, that novelty could potentially be a "high-risk, high-reward" strategy that pays off in the long run rather than the short run.

In plot H.1, we examine whether novelty is, in fact, correlated with long-term paper-level success. The left panel shows that, regardless of a paper's novelty, the mean percentile rank in citations for highly novel papers (in purple) and non-novel papers (in red) starts off quite similar within the first few years of publication. However, by the 10th year, papers ranked in the lowest quantile of novelty plateau and actually decline in ranking. Conversely, highly novel papers become more highly cited over time.

The same pattern is evident in the right panel. For the first 10 years after publication, novelty appears to be orthogonal to raw citation count. However, after the 10th year, the most novel group of papers begins to be slightly more cited, while the least novel group plateaus. By the 15th year, a noticeable gap emerges, where novelty is positively associated with citation count.

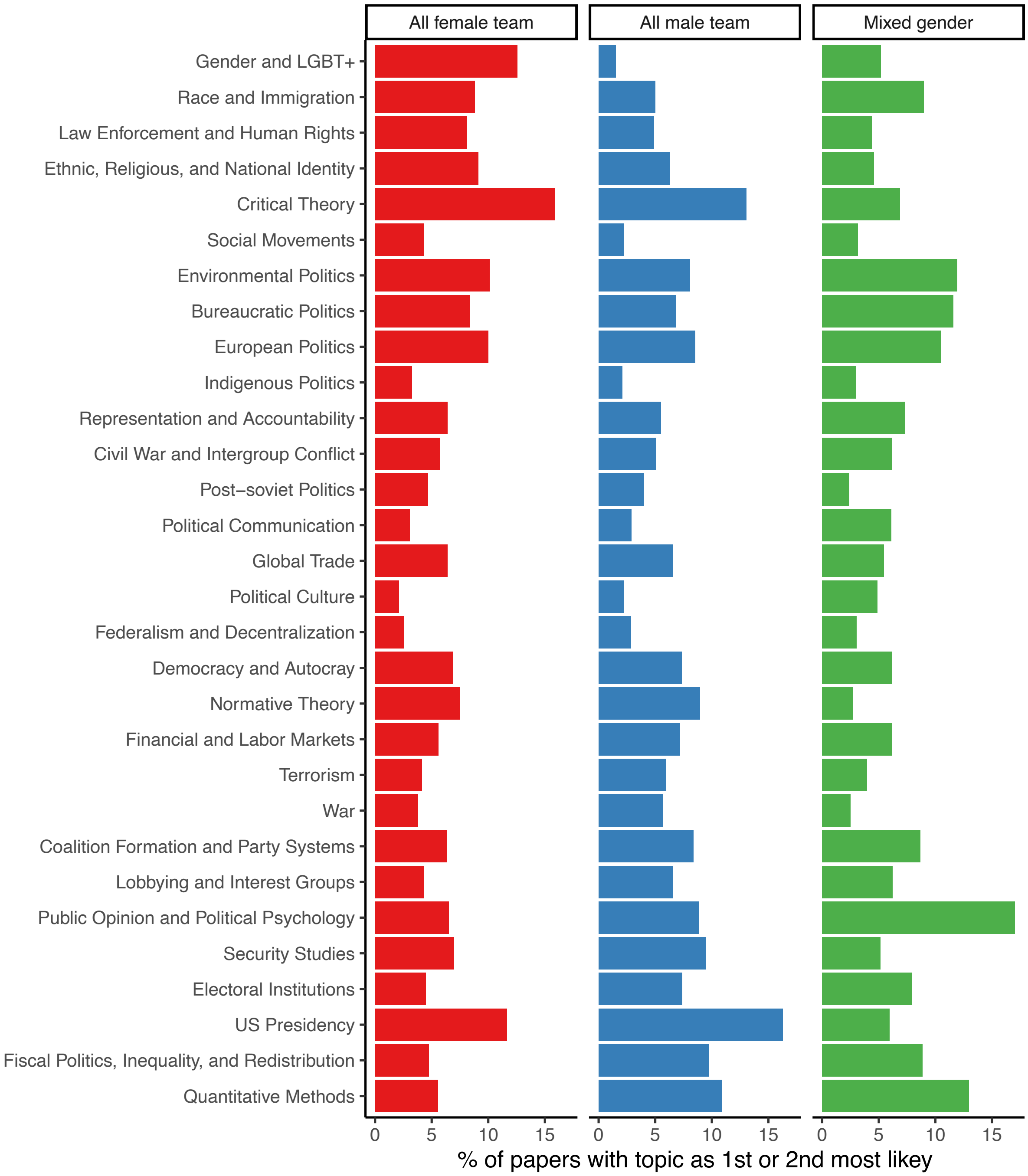

Figure H9: Figure shows the percentage of papers written by all female teams (in red), all male teams(in blue), and mixed gender teams (in green) with each topic as the 1st or 2nd most common

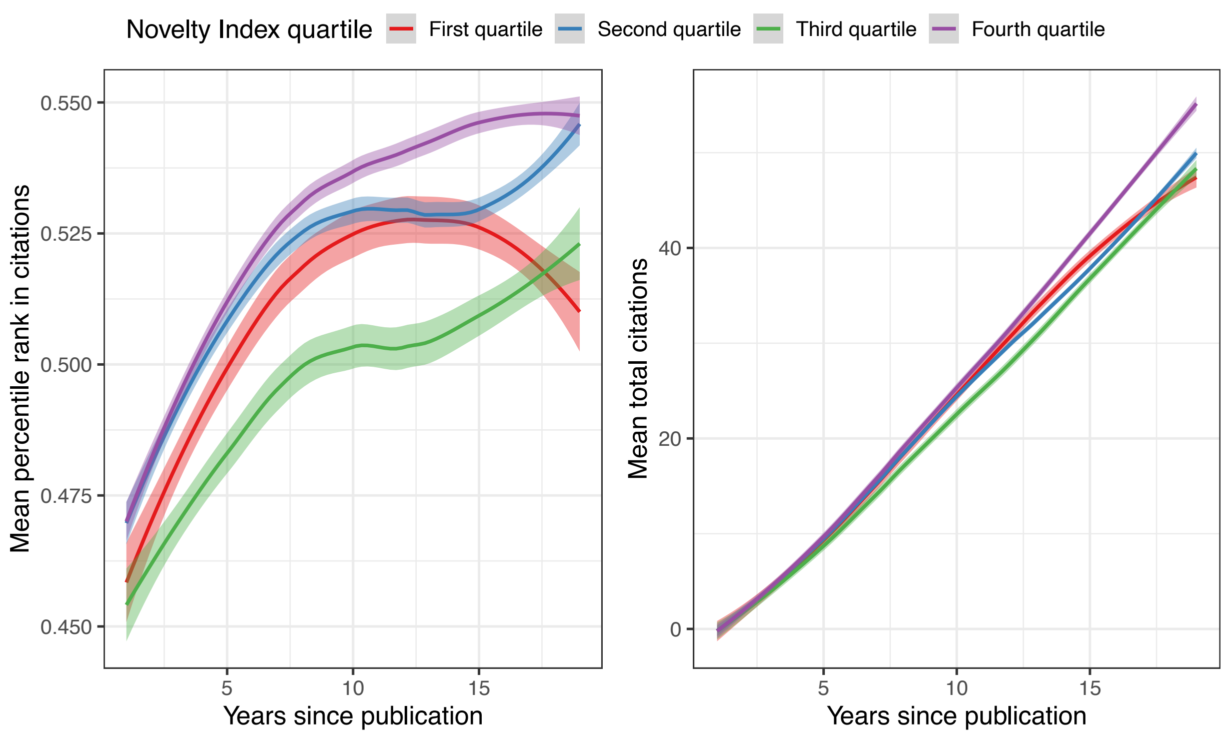

Figure H10: The left panel shows the mean percentile rank in citations of papers in the first (red), second (blue), third (green), and fourth (purple) quartile of novelty as years since publication increases. The right panel shows the mean raw count of total citations for papers in each of these two groups as years since publication increases.

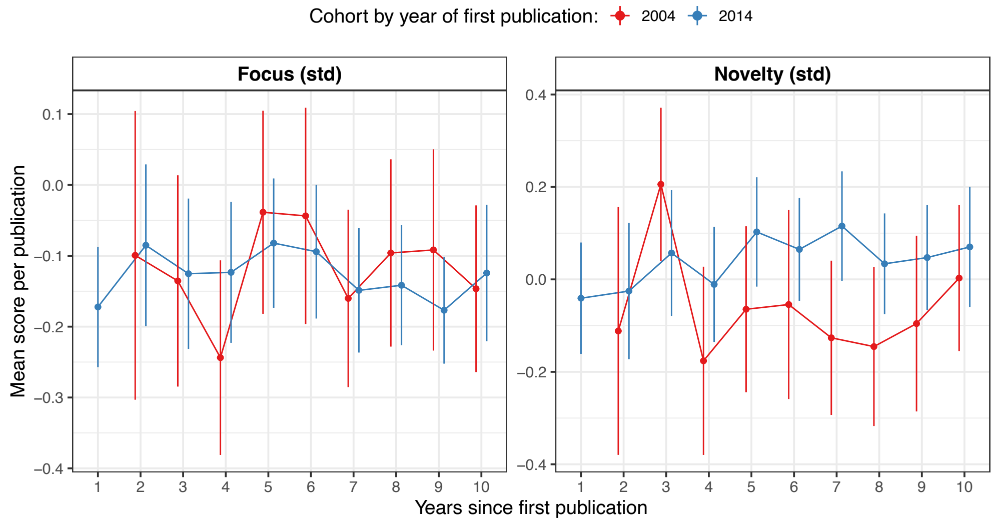

Figure H11: Mean yearly paper novelty (left panel) and focus (right panel) score, for political scientists who first published in 2004 (red) or 2014 (blue). Political scientists are defined as researchers who published five or more papers in their first decade, with at least half appearing in political science outlets. Novelty and focus measures are standardized within year using the entire sample of papers.

H.2 Focus and Novelty across Cohorts

In section 5 we explore how topical novelty and diversity have evolved in the discipline. We find that collaboration spurs novelty, which we explain partly as the result of teams distributing the potential risk of working on a seldom explored topical combination. In this section we complement the analysis with a cohort analysis. We again focus on "survivors" in the discipline: those who published at least five papers in ten years, half of them in our political science journal sample. We compare two cohorts of political scientists, those who first published in 2004 and those who did so in 2014, over 10 years, and calculate the mean yearly novelty and focus scores per paper published by these authors (standardized within year using the entire sample of papers). Figure H11 plots the results. We see no difference in focus between these two cohorts. However, we do see an increase in novelty for the younger cohort after the third year. This modest difference likely reflects the general equilibrium of two countervailing forces: while increased collaboration enables greater novelty through risk-sharing, mounting publication pressures simultaneously push researchers toward safer topical choices. Overall, however, it seems that younger cohorts of political scientists are slightly more novel than their older peers.